

Features

MPC comes as a simple stand alone executable—no installation files, no registry entries or other bloat. The interface is Spartan: unlike most other players that load up on the menus and decrease the viewing area, MPC's menus are modular, so unwanted components can be hidden. The full screen mode can be configured to include or exclude aids like the control bar and seek bar. One can change different properties of the video such as contrast, brightness, colour saturation, etc., provided the video codec allows it. The playback rate can be altered (fast forward or rewind) and audio is supported, up to 2X speed. MPC also allows capturing from Web cam or TV tuner. It also can encode files to DSM format. It has an inbuilt HTTP server which makes it easier to host your streaming, captured video, and the player can be remotely controlled through the Web interface.

Playing a video source (file or disk) is easy. Just go to File > Quick Open and browse for the video file. If it is a DVD or VCD that you intend to play, choose **File > Open DVD/VCD**. The control bar allows you to increase or decrease the play rate. At 2X speed, the audio takes a comic, high pitch turn; while at 0.5x speeds you can get everyone to speak like Elvis. To capture images of the movie, use the **File > Save Image** option. Unfortunately, the image will be in the resolution of the movie and not the window. The File > Save thumbnail option will give you a single file containing many screen grabs the size and layout of which can be configured. To customise the interface, play around in the View menu. Enable or Disable toolbars according to your choice. Alternatively, you can also use the preset styles under View > Presets. If the video appears too dim, increase its brightness. To do this, use the Play > Filters > MPEG 1 (or corresponding Video Codec) Video Renderer option. You can also increase contrast, colour and hue similarly.

If the basic walkthroughs are boring, then you can try using the advanced features of MPC.